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James Martinez/Gulf News

DUBAI'S WINTER WONDERLAND

The Madinat Jumeirah Festive Market, which runs until December 31, transforms the 1,750 sqm event space into a winter wonderland, featuring a towering 36-foot Christmas tree, festive abra tours hosted by Santa, and a Ferris wheel with spectacular views of the glittering market below. The Market draws over 400,000 visitors each year, creating a magical holiday experience filled with live music, entertainment, dining, and shopping. **SEE ALSO P8-9,15,16**

Dubai gold prices break record twice in a day amid global surge

Dubai 24K gold touches Dh531.50, peaking twice yesterday on Fed bets

DUBAI
BY NIVETHA DAYANAND
Assistant Business Editor

Gold prices in Dubai rocketed to a fresh all-time high for the second time yesterday, reaching Dh531.50 per gram for 24-carat by 4:15pm after touching Dh526.50 at 7:45am. The 22-carat variety climbed to Dh492.25 from Dh487.50, mirroring a global surge that puts both grades on track for their best year since 1979.

The metal jumped over 1.5 per cent internationally to top its prior \$4,381 per ounce peak from October, with silver gaining as much as 3.4 per cent toward \$70. Traders price in two Federal Reserve cuts for 2026 amid unclear US

1.5%

jump by gold to top its previous \$4,381 peak in October

data, while President Donald Trump pushes for aggressive easing. Lower rates boost non-yielding assets like gold.

Escalating flashpoints amplified safe-haven flows. The US ramped up its Venezuela oil blockade, boarding a third tanker to squeeze President Nicolás Maduro. Ukraine struck a Russian shadow fleet vessel in the Mediterranean for the first time. Such risks, plus Trump's trade threats, drove nearly 70 per cent yearly gains fuelled by central bank buys and ETF inflows.

December tracked steady climbs, with 24-carat rising from Dh511.75 on December 1 to yesterday's double peaks.

The past two weeks showed relentless momentum on investor bets and global benchmarks.

Big rebound

Gold rebounded hard from an October dip seen as overstretched. Goldman Sachs forecasts \$4,900 per ounce in 2026 base case, with ETF demand now vying with banks for tight supply.

The World Gold Council highlighted resilience in its report. "In a turbulent year marked by heightened macroeconomic and geopolitical risks, gold's volatility has increased alongside that of other assets, including major equity indices. That said, its long-term behaviour has remained broadly consistent, and comparable to that of other growth assets."

Sharp spikes proved short-lived, it noted, as gold cuts portfolio risk amid fading diversification tools.

— With inputs from Bloomberg



SPORT

Harrington joins stellar Dubai Desert Classic line-up

More high-profile players confirm for big event | **P13**

Trump is Google's most searched person in 2025

Music accounted for half of the top ten

DUBAI
BY NIVETHA DAYANAND
Assistant Business Editor

Politics, technology and entertainment dominated global search behaviour in 2025, with a small group of public figures accounting for a disproportionate share of online attention, according to an analysis by PlayersTime using Ahrefs search volume data.

Based on average monthly global Google searches over the past 12 months, Donald Trump emerged as the world's most searched

person in 2025, drawing nearly 16 million searches per month. He was followed by Elon Musk with just under 11 million searches, reinforcing the dominance of US political and business figures in shaping global attention.

Music accounted for half of the top ten most searched individuals globally. Taylor Swift ranked among the most searched figures, alongside Sabrina Carpenter, XXXTentacion and Romeo Santos, each generating between 6 and 8 million monthly searches.



Dubai's new 'RV route' to boost tourism

RECREATIONAL VEHICLE ROUTE TO CONNECT DEDICATED STATIONS, PARKS

DUBAI
BY SAJILA SASEENDRAN
Chief Reporter

Imagine exploring Dubai's stunning deserts, beaches, and mountains from the comfort of your own mobile home, with dedicated stops and parks designed specifically for your journey.

This vision becomes a reality as Dubai Municipality introduces the UAE's first integrated recreational vehicle route, opening new possibilities for outdoor adventure and family exploration across the emirate.

Dubai Municipality announced the initiative yesterday, establishing a comprehensive network of RV stations, serviced parks, and connected road trip experiences. The project positions Dubai as the region's premier destination for RV tourism while creating fresh outdoor recreation opportunities for residents and visitors alike.

Personalised road trips

Recreational vehicles that range from caravans and campervans to luxury motorhomes offer flexible accommodation with kitchens, restrooms, and living quarters, perfect for personalised road trips and weekend getaways.

The RV network spans Dubai's varied landscapes, offering families year-round opportunities to explore through connected road-trip journeys. Program-

The RV network spans Dubai's varied landscapes, offering families year-round opportunities to explore through connected road-trip journeys.

ming and facilities cater to all age groups, emphasising safety, comfort, and environmental responsibility while strengthening family bonds through shared outdoor experiences.

"The launch reflects Dubai Municipality's commitment to developing innovative and sustainable tourism models that enhance quality of life and create new economic opportunities," said Bader Anwahi, Chief Executive Officer of the Public Facilities Agency at Dubai Municipality.

Dubai Municipality will develop core infrastructure and regulatory frameworks, enabling private-sector developers to build, manage, and operate RV routes and parks.

The parks will integrate hospitality, dining, wellness, and recreational facilities designed for visitors of all ages and abilities. Through targeted marketing campaigns and international collaboration with tour operators, Dubai aims to attract manufacturers, service providers, and tourists, establishing itself as the gateway for regional RV tourism.

NATION | P5 TELL ME WHY



Tell Me Why Dubai's property market keeps breaking records with **Rana Hariz**, Executive Director at Palma Development

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BUSINESS

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